

bride should be a virgin, as he himself was. He would be told, often kindly: “But Herr Bruckner, you are too old!” These rebuffs, although always accepted, made him unhappy; one of them, combined with overwork, led in 1867 to a four-month nervous collapse. (Sechter’s warning had been remarkably perceptive.)



BRUCKNER’S HOUSE, BELVEDERE

The year before Bruckner’s death, the emperor of Austria, Franz Joseph, granted the aging musician rooms in the caretaker’s wing of the historic building complex of Belvedere, Vienna, so that he did not have to climb stairs.